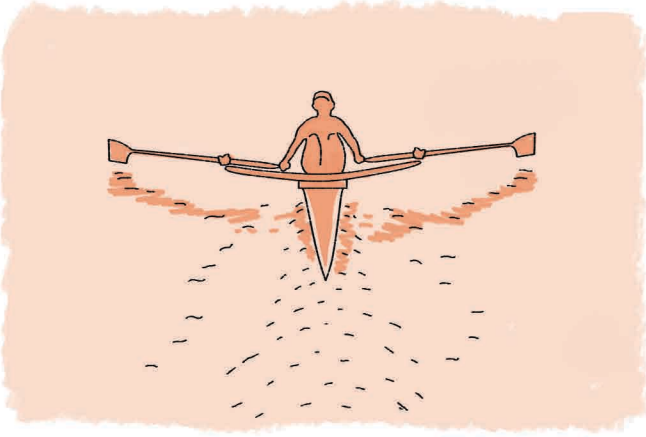
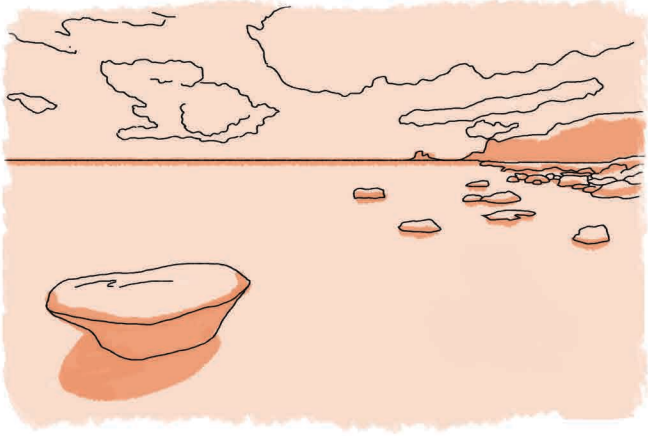
# BALANCE

**Balance** appears in every photograph we capture, weighing the visual weight on one side of the photo against the other. A balanced photo will feel pleasing and harmonious, whereas an unbalanced photo will feel uncomfortable and unresolved. One is not necessarily better than the other, it all depends on the feeling you're trying to evoke with your composition.



## Symmetrical

Symmetry is an example of perfect balance in a photograph, where each side of the image has the same visual weight. It's hard to find symmetry in nature, which can make it quite powerful when used well.



## Asymmetrical

Also known as informal balance, it is the most common compositional technique, taught in photography and art workshops. It requires intentionally placing your subject off center.

## Negative Space

Negative space defines and emphasizes the main subject of a photo, drawing your eye to it. It provides "breathing room", giving your eyes somewhere to rest and preventing your image from appearing too cluttered with "stuff".